

Drift — Prototype Residency

Forecast · Residencies · 8 weeks embedded

An 8-week embedded residency to build the working prototype that proves — or breaks — the diagnostic bet.

The three journeys

Narrative. You stopped debating the roadmap. The prototype settled the argument in six weeks.

Cognitive. Prototypes Garden: structured foresight scenarios wired to real data, real users, real ROI.

Identity. From meeting-holder to prototype-holder.

Curriculum by module

Module 1 — Week 1 — Bet recital

40h · Love — Why this matters

Outcome: User stories wall built.

Intent: Anchor the residency on the diagnostic bet's why.

Prompt question: Why did this org bet on this?

Exercise	Time	Prompt	Debrief
Bet Recital	15m	Kickoff opens by reading the diagnostic bet verbatim.	No commentary. Just witnessed.
User Story from the Bet	90m	Draft one user story per beneficiary of the bet.	Post to the residency room wall.
The Fear Refresh	150m	Ask 5 stakeholders: 'What are you afraid the prototype will show?'	Compare to diagnostic fear map.

Artifact: A wall of user stories. Refreshed fear map.

Module 2 — Week 2 — Fake first

40h · Magic — The reframe

Outcome: Fake-screen tests logged.

Intent: Break the default 'MVP' lens with 'evidence prototype'.

Prompt question: What is the smallest thing that would count as evidence?

Exercise	Time	Prompt	Debrief
Evidence Sketch	60m	Draw what a proof-image would look like. What screen? What chart? What quote?	Ask: 'What's the smallest thing that would move the room?'
The Fake-Screen Test	240m	Show one hand-drawn screen to 5 real users. Log reactions.	Ask: 'Did the sketch move them more than a real product would have?'
Wizard-of-Oz	180m	Run one full user interaction with a	Log every question the human

Round		human in the loop.	couldn't answer.
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Artifact: A sketchbook of evidence. Fake-screen test logs.

Module 3 — Week 3 — Bed choice

40h · Calm — Organize complexity

Outcome: Bed + criteria + risk posted.

Intent: Introduce the Prototypes Garden framework.

Prompt question: Which garden bed does this prototype belong in?

Exercise	Time	Prompt	Debrief
Garden Bed Assignment	60m	Pick: signal-testing, workflow, ontology, business-model, ecosystem. Justify.	Ask: 'Which bed did we default to? Was it right?'
Bed-Specific Success Criteria	45m	Write the 3 success criteria specific to this bed.	Circulate. Signal criteria differ from workflow criteria.
Cross-Bed Risk	30m	Every bed has a failure mode. Name yours.	Post next to the prototype wall.

Artifact: A bed assignment. Bed-specific criteria. Risk card.

Module 4 — Weeks 4-7 — Public build

160h · Open — Pattern discovery

Outcome: 4 weekly demos + failure log.

Intent: Build, test, learn — publicly.

Prompt question: What is the prototype telling us that we didn't expect?

Exercise	Time	Prompt	Debrief
The Weekly Demo	45m	Anyone in the org can attend. Log surprises.	Post the demo recording each week.
Failure Log	60m	Weekly note: what didn't work and why. Public channel.	Ask: 'Which failure taught the most?'
The Skeptic's Session	60m	Book a 60-min session with the person most likely to reject the prototype.	Log every objection. Address 3 next week.

Artifact: 8 weekly demo recordings. A failure log. Skeptic session notes.

Module 5 — Week 8 — Verdict

40h · Free — Commitment

Outcome: Verdict + handoff package.

Intent: Decide: kill, extend, or productionize.

Prompt question: Did the prototype prove or break the bet?

Exercise	Time	Prompt	Debrief
The Verdict Meeting	90m	90-min meeting. Verdict: kill / extend / productionize. In writing.	Read the verdict to the team same day.

Post-Mortem or Pre-Mortem	180m	Kill → post-mortem. Productionize → pre-mortem for launch.	Both circulated to the org.
The Handoff Package	240m	Bundle: prototype, evidence, verdict, post/pre-mortem, next-30-days plan.	Deliver to next team. Sign off.

Artifact: A written verdict. A post- or pre-mortem. A handoff package.

Commitment contract

What is the verdict on the diagnostic bet?

The prototype verdict is _____. The evidence is _____. The next 30 days will _____. The receiving team is _____.

Witness — The executive sponsor of the bet.